THE REAL ESTATE INVESTOR ID

Discover Your Niche, Map Your First 90 Days,
and Finally Know Where to Start

By Ron Breitenbach

Real Estate Investor Since 2010 · Part of a 40,000+ Investor Network

15 Years of Real Deals. Real Results. No Fluff.

Before You Read Another Word

If you've been thinking about getting into real estate for 1, 2, maybe 3 years — and you still haven't pulled the trigger — it's not because you're lazy. It's not because you don't want it bad enough. It's because nobody helped you figure out which kind of investor you actually are.

And when you don't know that, every piece of advice contradicts the last one. You read about fix and flip and get excited. Then you read about wholesaling and think that sounds better. Then someone tells you buy and hold is the real long-term money. So you go back and forth until you've convinced yourself you need to learn every strategy before you can start any of them.

That's the trap. And I'm going to get you out of it. THE TIME IS NOW.

> *"I was sick and tired of being sick and tired. But being tired wasn't enough — I needed a lane. Once I committed to my niche, everything else fell into place in 90 days."*
>
> **— Ron Breitenbach**

This guide gives you the Investor ID system — the same framework I use with every new investor I sit down with. By the time you finish it, you will know your niche, you will have a 90-day action plan built around your actual life, and you will understand the one protection rule that stands between your deals and financial disaster.

I've been investing in real estate since 2010. I don't have a 401k. My retirement is in deals. And the system in this guide has taken students from zero to six-figure yearly profits — and one Arizona couple from $200,000 a year to over a million.* It works. Let's get you started.

In this guide, you will discover:

✓ Which of the 5 real estate niches is built for your income, your schedule, and your risk tolerance — even if you've never done a deal before

✓ How to use the Investor ID Quiz to stop guessing and start knowing exactly where to go — in under 10 minutes

✓ The exact 90-day action plan for YOUR niche — so your first week isn't wasted figuring out where to start

✓ Why most investors spend 3–5 years spinning their wheels — and the one decision that cuts that to 90 days

✓ The LLC protection rule every investor must know before buying a single property — and the story of an Arizona couple who learned it the hard way (14 homes lost)

✓ What Ron did in his own first 90 days — and the homework assignment that produced a $14,000 payday for one of his students in week three*

Read this front to back. Do the quiz. Take the 90-day plan seriously. And then let's talk.

Section 1: Why Most People Never Pick a Niche

Here's what I see every time someone new comes to me after two or three years of 'getting ready': they know everything about every strategy — and they have not done a single deal. Not one. The reason is always the same. They never picked a lane.

Real estate has multiple paths. Fix and flip. Wholesale. Buy and hold. Land. Multi-family. Each one has its own rules, its own capital requirements, its own time demands, its own risk profile. And when you're trying to learn all of them at once, you end up being an expert in nothing and a doer of nothing.

I don't say that to be hard on you. I say it because I watch good people — motivated, hard-working people — delay their financial freedom by 2, 3, 5 years because they're in a research loop that never ends. You can't read your way into a deal. At some point, you have to make an offer.

> *"I don't care how much you know. I care how many offers you made this week."*
>
> **— Ron Breitenbach**

The investors who succeed in their first 90 days are not the ones who know the most. They're the ones who picked one niche, committed to it, and made offers. Commitment before competence. Action before certainty.

Now I'm not saying go in blind. That's what this guide is for. But there is a big difference between knowing your niche and knowing every niche. You need the first one. The second one will come with experience.

The Real Cost of Waiting

Here's a number that should make you uncomfortable: every year you wait to start investing in real estate, you are not just standing still. You are falling behind.

While you're watching videos, property values are appreciating. While you're reading books, someone else is collecting rent checks. While you're going to free seminars, an investor who started six months ago has already closed two deals and has cash in the bank you don't.

The cost of waiting is not zero. It is the income, appreciation, and equity you did not build while you were getting ready. I've been doing this since 2010. I don't have a 401k. My retirement plan is my portfolio. And the best investment I ever made wasn't a property — it was the decision to stop waiting and start doing.

The Niche Effect

Investors without a defined niche: avg. 3–5 years before first deal

Investors who pick a niche and commit: avg. 60–90 days before first deal

The difference is not talent, access to capital, or market conditions.

The difference is a single decision — picking a lane and staying in it.

The rest of this guide is going to help you make that decision. Not in a vague, think-about-it way. In a specific, THIS IS THE WAY kind of way. This is your niche and here is your first week. Let's do this. Just do it.

Section 2: The 5 Real Estate Investor Paths

There are five main paths you can take as a real estate investor. Every one of them is legitimate. Every one of them has produced real wealth. Your job right now is not to find the 'best' strategy — it's to find the one that fits your actual life. We'll use the quiz in the next section to lock that in.

Read through all five. Even the ones that don't feel right yet. Understanding the landscape makes you a better investor at every stage.

Path 1: Fix and Flip

You buy a distressed property, renovate it, and sell it for a profit. This is what most people picture when they think of real estate investing — and it's real, it works, and it produces fast, chunky cash when done right.

But let's be straight about what it demands. Fix and flip is an active business. You're managing contractors, overseeing renovation timelines, dealing with inspections, permits, and surprise costs that will always be higher than you expected. If you want passive income and you don't want to be on a jobsite, this is not your starting point.

The math works like this: in Arizona, the max FHA mortgage for a single-family home is approximately $525,000. So picking up a distressed property at $175,000–$250,000, renovating it to an appraised value of $420,000+, produces a real margin — IF you know your renovation numbers cold before you buy. That's non-negotiable.*

Fix and Flip — At a Glance

Capital required: Yes — yours, hard money lenders, or private investors

Time commitment: High — active management through the renovation

Income type: Lump-sum profit at sale (no monthly cash flow during the hold)

Risk level: Moderate to high — renovation cost overruns are the #1 deal killer

Best for: Investors with time, capital access, and appetite for active hands-on work

One key rule for fix and flip: never get emotionally attached to the property. You are not decorating your dream home. You are running a business. Make decisions with math, not emotion. The moment you start upgrading cabinets and countertops because they'd look nice, you are eating into your margin.

Path 2: Wholesale

This is where most beginners should start — and where most of my students have made their first dollar in real estate. Wholesaling is simple: you find a distressed property with a motivated seller, get it under contract at a price below market, and then sell that contract to another investor for an assignment fee.

You never own the property. You never need a bank loan. You don't need perfect credit. You don't need a real estate license in most states. What you need is hustle, a phone, and the discipline to make offers consistently.

> *"It doesn't have to be your credit. It doesn't have to be your capital. But it has to be your hustle."*
>
> **— Ron Breitenbach**

One of my students — no experience, no real estate background, no significant capital — made a $14,000* payday in week three. Not week thirty. Week three. Because she picked this path, committed to it, and made ten offers that first week. That's the wholesale model in action.

Wholesale — At a Glance

Capital required: Minimal — only earnest money ($500–$2,000 in most cases — borrow it if needed)

Time commitment: Moderate — active work finding deals and buyers

Income type: Assignment fee per deal ($5,000–$25,000+ per transaction)

Risk level: Low — you never hold the property, no renovation exposure

Best for: Beginners, investors without capital, people who want to learn the market fast

Path 3: Buy and Hold (Rental Properties)

This is the long game. You buy a property, rent it out, and collect cash flow every month. Over time, the property appreciates, your tenants pay down your mortgage, and you build real wealth that compounds year after year.

Here's what most people get wrong about rentals: they think they need to renovate to a high standard. They don't. Renters don't care about granite countertops or custom cabinets. They

need a safe, clean place to lay their head and take a shower before they go to work the next morning. Minimal fix-up on rentals means more cash flow from day one — don't over-improve.

And this is important: it doesn't have to be your credit, and it doesn't have to be your capital. A business partner with strong credit can be the borrower while you bring the deal-finding hustle. Structure it right with your attorney, and you're both winning.

Buy and Hold — At a Glance

Capital required: Financing needed — can be your credit, a partner's, or creative structures

Time commitment: Low to moderate once the tenant is placed

Income type: Monthly cash flow + long-term appreciation + mortgage paydown

Risk level: Moderate — vacancy, tenant turnover, and maintenance are the main variables

Best for: W-2 earners who want passive income, investors building long-term wealth

Path 4: Land Investing

Land is one of the least talked-about and most misunderstood niches in real estate — and that gap creates opportunity. You buy raw land, rural parcels, or infill lots at a discount, and you either sell them for more, subdivide them, or hold for future development value.

The entry barrier is lower than most residential paths because raw land is affordable, there are no tenants, no roofs, no plumbing, no appliances. Your primary risk is demand and liquidity — land can take longer to sell than a house. But for the patient investor, land builds real wealth without the headaches of active management.

Land Investing — At a Glance

Capital required: Low — raw land is among the most affordable entry points in real estate

Time commitment: Low — no tenants, no contractors, no property management

Income type: Profit at sale, owner financing income, or future development value

Risk level: Low to moderate — primarily demand and liquidity risk

Best for: Patient investors who want a low-maintenance, low-drama entry point

Path 5: Multi-Family — The Four-Plex Advantage

This is my personal favorite. And there's a very specific reason why.

An FHA loan for a four-plex can go up to approximately $1,000,000 in many markets — meaning you can finance a four-unit property with a relatively low down payment, live in one unit, and let the other three tenants pay your mortgage. Once you move out, it becomes a pure cash-flow machine.

Offerpad is a site I always send new investors to. Property owners who've been trying to rent their duplexes and four-plexes for months and are frustrated that the unit is sitting empty — that frustration is your opportunity. You're solving their problem while building your portfolio. That's how this works.

Make a list of the properties: how close, how far, how big, how small. Remember — you may not want to live in the property you're looking at, but someone will. And you never, ever get attached to an asset. It's a property that can be bought, sold, held, or rented. That's it.

Multi-Family — At a Glance

Capital required: FHA financing available up to ~$1M for a four-plex

Time commitment: Moderate — managing multiple tenants

Income type: Multiple rental income streams — strongest per-property cash flow

Risk level: Moderate — mitigated by multiple income units (if one tenant leaves, three remain)

Best for: Investors who want maximum cash flow per property and can house-hack initially

Section 3: The Investor ID Quiz

Answer these five questions honestly. Not the answers you wish were true — the answers that are actually true about your life right now. There is no wrong result. There is only the path that fits where you are today.

Circle or note your answers, then check the results at the end of this section.

Question 1: How much time can you dedicate to real estate each week?

- A. Less than 5 hours — I have a demanding job and real family obligations
- B. 5–15 hours — I can carve out evenings and weekends
- C. 15–30 hours — I'm treating this like a part-time business right now
- D. 30+ hours — I'm ready to go all in and make this my primary focus

Question 2: What is your capital situation right now?

- A. No significant capital and credit challenges — I'm starting from scratch
- B. I have some capital or access to it through a partner or family member
- C. I have solid capital or strong financing options ($50,000+)
- D. I have significant capital or access to private money ($100,000+)

Question 3: What is your primary income goal from real estate?

- A. Fast cash — I want to see income in the next 60–90 days
- B. Monthly cash flow — I want consistent, passive income over time
- C. Long-term wealth — I want to build equity and net worth over years
- D. Both — I want income now AND I'm building for the long game

Question 4: How hands-on do you want to be in your investments?

- A. Fully hands-off — I want to invest and check in from a distance
- B. Moderately involved — I'll manage relationships but not physical work
- C. Very hands-on — I'm comfortable managing projects, contractors, and timelines
- D. Flexible — I'll do whatever the best strategy requires

Question 5: What is your comfort level with risk?

- A. Low — I want to learn the market without putting much capital at risk
- B. Moderate — some risk is fine if the upside is clear and I understand it
- C. High — I'm willing to take on more risk for bigger, faster returns
- D. I don't know yet — I need more experience before I can answer this honestly

*Any answer you give will not exclude you.**

Your Investor ID Results

Here's how to read your answers. The goal is not to find the flashiest strategy — it's to find the one that you can actually execute with your life as it is right now. Where you start doesn't define where you end up. It just defines where you start.

Mostly A answers

Your Investor ID: The Wholesaler

You need income without significant capital or a major time commitment. Wholesale is your lane. You can make your first $5,000–$20,000* without a bank, without owning a property, and without quitting your job. Start here, build cash, and expand from a position of strength.

Mostly B answers

Your Investor ID: The Buy-and-Hold Investor

You have some capital access, a moderate time window, and you want monthly income. Buy and hold — ideally a duplex or four-plex — is your path. Focus on properties with strong rental demand, minimal fix-up required, and solid cash-on-cash returns in your target market.

Mostly C answers

Your Investor ID: The Fix-and-Flip Investor

You're high-energy, have capital access, can commit significant time, and have an appetite for active deals. Fix and flip is your path. Know your ARV before every offer. Know your renovation budget before you go under contract. And never fall in love with a property. Math only.

Mostly D answers

Your Investor ID: The Multi-Family Investor

You're committed, well-capitalized or willing to be, flexible on approach, and want maximum returns per property. Four-plexes and multi-family assets are your lane. FHA financing options extend up to $1M for a four-plex — meaning you can house-hack and let your tenants fund your mortgage.

Want direct access to Ron?

Text the word SUMMIT to get started:

https://wa.me/15203437331?text=SUMMIT

Section 4: Your First 90 Days

You have your Investor ID. Now let's build your first 90 days. This framework applies across all niches — what changes is the specific action at each step. The phases are the same. The targets are the same. The execution looks slightly different depending on your path.

Print this section. Write in the margins. Give yourself a deadline for each phase. The investors who treat this like homework get deals done. The ones who treat it like interesting reading stay in research mode forever.

Phase 1 — Weeks 1–2: Foundation Before Action

Before you look at a single property, complete these four things. In this order.

1. Set up your LLC. This is not optional and I will cover exactly why in Section 5. But do this first. Before you make a single offer. Before you walk through a single property. Set it up.
2. Call a mortgage broker. Ask them one question: what is the maximum FHA loan for a single-family home and for a four-plex in my target county? You need that ceiling number before you evaluate a single deal. It tells you the top of the market.
3. Set up your property search. Create accounts on realtor.com, zillow.com, and Offerpad. Set search alerts for your target zip codes. Facebook Marketplace is also worth watching — search 'handyman special' and 'as-is' in your area.
4. Show up to a local real estate investor association (REIA) meeting. You don't need to say much. You're building a network that will produce deals, partners, buyers, and lenders for the next 15 years.

Phase 2 — Weeks 3–4: Building Your Property Radar

Your target in Phase 2 is a list of 20 properties on your radar. Not properties you've made offers on — properties you've identified, researched, and are ready to evaluate seriously. Here's where to find them:

- Realtor.com — Ron's personal first stop. Filter for price reductions, high days on market, and 'as-is' listings. These are your signals.
- Zillow.com — Look for 'price reduced' tags and properties that have been sitting 60+ days. Motivated sellers hide in plain sight here.
- Offerpad — Owners who are trying and failing to rent or sell. That frustration is your leverage.

- Facebook Marketplace — Search ‘handyman special’, ‘needs work’, and ‘as-is’ in your target area.
- Craigslist — Still alive, still producing deals. Search ‘cash sale’, ‘motivated seller’, and ‘fixer upper’.
- Google Search — ‘Distressed property [your city]’, ‘motivated seller [your city]’, ‘sell house fast [your city]’.
- Driving for Dollars — Old school. Still works. Drive your target neighborhood and note addresses of distressed, vacant, or neglected properties. Find the owner through county tax records.

For each property you find, track: address, asking price, estimated condition, size, and distance from you. You’re not making offers yet. You’re building your list and learning your market.

Phase 3 — Weeks 5–8: Making Offers — Time to Get Off the Couch

This is the phase where most investors freeze. Don’t. This is Ron’s non-negotiable rule: make 10 offers this week. Not 2. Not 5. Ten. Every week, for four weeks straight. I don’t care if everyone gets rejected. I care that you made them.

> *“You’re gonna fumble your words. You’re gonna not know exactly what to say. That’s fine. I was there too. You gotta get started.”*
>
> **— Ron Breitenbach**

Call agents: ‘I’m an investor looking in this area. I move fast and I’m serious.’ OpenDoor will give you a code to walk properties — use it. Walk everything. Wear clothes you don’t mind getting dirty. Good shoes. Some properties will be clean. Some will need real work. Be prepared for both.

For every offer, run the numbers first. For fix and flip: what is the ARV and what does it cost to get there? For wholesale: what would another investor pay for it, and what margin do you need? For buy and hold: what does it rent for, and what does the cash-on-cash return look like? Never make an emotional offer. Only math-based offers.

Phase 4 — Weeks 9–12: Closing Your First Deal

By week nine, if you've been making 10 offers per week, you have made 40+ offers. Some got rejected outright. Some counter-offered. One or two accepted or are very close. This is where you close.

For wholesale: due diligence, confirm your buyer, assign the contract, collect your fee. For buy and hold or fix and flip: inspections, financing finalization, and closing. Your first deal will not be perfect. That's not the goal. The goal is to do it, learn from it, and do the next one better.

The student who made $14,000* in week three didn't know everything about real estate. She knew her niche, she made offers, and she followed through when one of them said yes. That's all this is.

Section 5: The LLC Protection Rule

I saved this for near the end because I want it to be the thing that sticks. This is not the exciting part of the guide. But it is the most important. Every investor I've seen lose everything — or lose a lot — has had one thing in common: they didn't have the right structure in place before they needed it.

The rule: set up your LLC before you close your first deal. Not your second. Your first.

The Story That Proves Why

I know a couple in Arizona. They were building a real estate portfolio — doing everything right on the deal side. Good properties. Good markets. But they didn't have their legal entity structure properly set up. Every property they owned was exposed.

Then a lawsuit came. One judgment. And because their assets weren't properly protected through the right entity structure, that judgment cascaded through their entire portfolio.

They lost 14 homes.

> *"Fourteen homes. Not because they made bad deals. Because they didn't have the right structure protecting those deals."*
>
> **— Ron Breitenbach**

I'm not sharing that to scare you out of investing. I'm sharing it so you never end up in that position. The protection is simple to set up. It is not expensive. And it must happen before you buy anything — not after your first deal closes.

What You Need to Do Before Deal One

1. Consult a real estate attorney in your state. LLC rules, asset protection laws, and entity structuring requirements vary by state. Don't copy what worked in someone else's state. Get advice for your specific market.
2. Set up the right entity structure for your investing strategy. A wholesaler structures differently than a long-term rental investor. Your attorney will guide you. What's non-negotiable is that the structure exists before deal one.

3. Never hold property in your personal name. Every asset should sit in the appropriate entity. Period.
4. Ask about umbrella insurance policies in addition to your LLC. Multiple layers of protection are how experienced investors sleep at night.

Also: before you look at a single property, Google 'max FHA mortgage [your county]' or call a mortgage broker and ask them directly. Know the lending ceiling for your area. That number tells you the top of the market, which helps you evaluate every deal you look at.

The Rule: Protect Before You Buy

1. Talk to a real estate attorney in your state before closing deal one.
2. Set up your LLC before your first deal. Not after.
3. Never hold property in your personal name.
4. Revisit your structure with your attorney every year as your portfolio grows.
5. Ask about umbrella insurance as an additional protection layer.

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What You Just Learned — And What Comes Next

Let's be clear about what you have after reading this guide.

- You have your Investor ID — the niche that fits your income, your time, and your risk tolerance right now.
- You know the 5 paths — and why picking one is the difference between closing a deal in 90 days and spinning your wheels for 5 years.
- You have a 90-day framework — four phases, week by week, so your first week is never wasted.
- You know where to find motivated sellers — seven sources, from realtor.com to driving for dollars.
- You know the LLC protection rule — and you know exactly what to do before your first deal closes.

Here's the Problem Your Investor ID Just Created

You now know which niche is built for your life. Most investors never get that clarity. That is real progress.

But knowing your niche and executing your first deal in your niche are two different things. A guide can't tell you which specific property to pursue in your market right now. It can't tell you whether to offer $175K or $215K on the house you found on realtor.com. It can't tell you if the neighborhood you're looking at is about to turn or already turned. It can't tell you if your state's LLC structure matches what you're planning to do.

That's the gap. You have a map. What you don't have yet is someone who has walked this exact terrain in your exact market and can tell you: here is the move, here is the offer, here is the call you make this week.

The 20-Minute Call That Changes Everything

I take five free 20-minute strategy calls per week. On the call, I look at your Investor ID personally, confirm your niche based on your actual situation — your income, your schedule, your risk tolerance, your market — and I give you the specific first three moves. Not generic advice. Your moves, for your situation.

I've been doing this for 15 years. I don't have a team of closers calling you back. I don't sugarcoat things, and I pick up the phone. You'll walk away with more clarity in 20 minutes than most investors get from 6 more months of YouTube.

No pitch. No obligation. Just your roadmap.

Book your free 20-minute Investor ID Strategy Call with Ron.

5 slots per week. Ron personally reviews your Investor ID on every call.

No pitch. No obligation. Just the next move for your situation.

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